

Xavier Tierney

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Department of Economics, London School of Economics, Houghton Street, London WC2A 2AE
x.tierney@lse.ac.uk · xavier-tierney.github.io

EDUCATION

London School of Economics PhD in Economics, expected 2027	2021–present
London School of Economics MRes in Economics, with Distinction	2023
London School of Economics MSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, with Distinction	2021
University of Oxford, Balliol College BA in Physics and Philosophy, First Class Honours	2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Urban **Secondary:** Development, Labour

JOB MARKET PAPER

City Shape: Costs and Responses with Evidence from Sydney

Many cities are settled near geographic boundaries such as harbors or mountains. As they grow, they are forced to spread into distorted, non-compact urban footprints, with longer travel times than circular cities. Moreover, if the city sprawls in one direction, building investments and agglomeration forces can leave the center of business stranded at the far end of the city. As low-income residents are most likely to be pushed to the periphery, the resulting costs of reduced access to the center may be most directly borne by the worst off. In this paper, I bring evidence on the costs and possible responses to these effects of distorted city shape using a structural model calibrated to Sydney. First, I perform stylised counterfactuals to estimate the costs and their incidence, finding that bad shape can substantially worsen commute times, wages and output, and can contribute to inequality. I then estimate the effects of a government policy to shift public service jobs to areas with lower employment access.

TEACHING

PP440 Micro and Macro Economics for Public Policy (graduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Luis Garicano and Ethan Ilzetzki	2024/25, 2025/26
EC1A5 Microeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Alan Manning	2023/24
EC1B5 Macroeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE Teaching assistant for Rachel Ngai and Keyu Jin	2022/23, 2023/24
Awards: LSE Excellence in Education Award (2025); Economics Department teaching bonus award (2023, 2024)	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Gharad Bryan, LSE	2024
Research Assistant to Professors Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess, LSE	2019–2020
Research Scholar, Future of Humanity Institute, University of Oxford Salaried research fellowship. Worked with the Centre for the Governance of AI on market concentration, the economics of protectionism and trends in technological progress	2018–2019
Research Assistant to Professor Armin Reichold, Particle Physics, University of Oxford	2018

HONOURS AND AWARDS

LSE Job Market Fund	2026–2027
LSE Excellence in Education Award	2025
LSE Economics Department teaching bonus award	2023, 2024

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming: R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, QGIS, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Citizenship: Australia, the Netherlands

REFERENCES

Daniel Sturm

Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
d.m.sturm@lse.ac.uk

Gharad Bryan

Associate Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
g.t.bryan@lse.ac.uk

Henry Overman

Professor of Economic Geography
London School of Economics
h.g.overman@lse.ac.uk